Isolation Is Not the Harm: Mechanized Anomaly Predicates, Verified Disciplines, and the Residue They Leave in Multi-Agent LLM Systems

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Abstract—An agent's step in a multi-agent LLM system is a transaction whose compute phase is an inference call of unbounded latency, during which the state it read is neither locked nor re-validated. We port four classical consistency conditions to this regime as history predicates—stale generation, phantom tool, causal cascade, tool-effect reordering—prove (TLAPS) that stale-generation freedom implies commit-order read consistency under three stated hypotheses, and realize the 2^4 exclusion lattice by bounded model checking (two agents, two cells, two operations), with the disciplines of one chain verified in Verus and the L_1, L_2 and L_4 bytes that were verified the bytes that are measured. The central empirical finding is that isolation is not the harm. On an unmodified LangGraph runtime under live models, read-set validation removes every commit grounded in a superseded read, yet the booking still contradicts the final trip date in 2–63% of sessions on the API families (100% behind a request-serializing local server), because the revision landed after the commit; sweeping the race offset from 0 to 1.5 s drives the predicate to 0 and that residue to 52%. The residue is not a concurrency anomaly—it occurs in correct sequential executions—and no commit-time discipline reaches it. We define it as a predicate on effects and their recovered bases, show that under an open-world store it can only be owed, and realize a basis ledger that registers the obligation atomically; with a rebooking compensator it ends with $0/100$ wrong bookings on three API families where the two L_1 arms of the same run leave 2–63, a store-level outcome, and we state exactly what it does not show about a world with a consumer and a compensator that can fail. Two further findings concern deployed executors: a released tool executor batches an order-dependent pipeline on $30/30$ turns of one backbone, commits its effects out of order on 22 of them, and shows them in order in the transcript every time, and a human-in-the-loop resumption path emits an irreversible effect twice, a hazard we state as a fifth predicate with its witness. Per sound committed operation, snapshot isolation costs $+0.4$–11.1% in tokens and pessimistic locking up to $+97\%$; a census of 98 public LangGraph repositories finds the stale-generation precondition confirmed in no graph site (at most about half counting unresolved ones), a negative prevalence result. Every number carries its receipt and its assurance level, and every gap between a predicate and the harm it tracks is stated.

Index Terms—Multi-agent systems, large language models, memory consistency, isolation levels, formal verification, TLA+, Verus.

1 Introduction

A multi-agent LLM system shares state. One agent writes a plan that another reads; a tool registry is consulted at planning time and called at execution time; a supervisor retracts a decision that a worker has already acted on. Each agent's step has the shape of a transaction—read, compute, commit—with one difference from every setting in which transactions have been studied: the compute phase is a neural-inference call that takes seconds to minutes, during which the read set is neither locked nor cheaply re-validated. Deployed frameworks place this phase inside a pinned snapshot (LangGraph's superstep), a re-rendered context (Letta) or a message queue (AutoGen), and none of them states what guarantee the shared state carries across it.

1.1 A failure, constructed and then observed

Two agents share a trip record. A flight agent reads "trip date = 14 June," drafts a reservation over a model call, and books it. During that call a second agent, acting for the user, moves the trip to 21 June. The flight agent commits a 14 June booking beside a 21 June trip date. No component failed; the history is even serializable, in the order in which the flight agent runs to completion and the revision follows. What it is not is serializable *in the order in which its operations committed*: the revision committed first, and a flight agent executing after it would have read 21 June. Figure 1 draws the shape.

We ran this scenario on an unmodified LangGraph runtime under live models (Section 6.1). With the second agent started inside the first agent's generation window, the framework committed the stale booking in every session in which the revision landed inside the window—60% and 91% of sessions on two API models, the remainder landing after the commit—and read-set validation at commit removed every such firing. The same data record a second fact the predicate does not see: when the revision lands *after* the commit, the booking contradicts the final trip date just the same, and no isolation discipline can prevent it. We report both numbers throughout, because the distance between them is the distance between a consistency predicate and the harm it is meant to track. The rates themselves are properties of the race we opened (a 150 ms offset; swept from 0 to 1.5 s in Figure 2) and we attach no prevalence reading to them.

What this paper is not claiming. A census of 98 public LangGraph repositories (Section 6.9) finds the structural precondition of the failure above—a reader and a writer of one last-value channel scheduled together—confirmed in none of 407 graph sites, with eight unresolved. We take that at face value: public LangGraph code is mostly sequential, and four of five frameworks we probed close the window by construction. The regime studied here is the one

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Artifact: https://github.com/sajjadanwar0/mac-consistency-mono, release tag `v4.1-tse`*, cut at submission by a gate that refuses while any cell of this text is still marked pending (TLA+ models, Verus proofs, the reference runtime, every harness, and the committed traces behind every table;* `reproduce.sh` *re-derives each figure from committed data and* `CLAIMS.json` *is the one source of every number the text states). A supplementary document (§§ A–W) holds raw tables and proofs omitted here for length.*

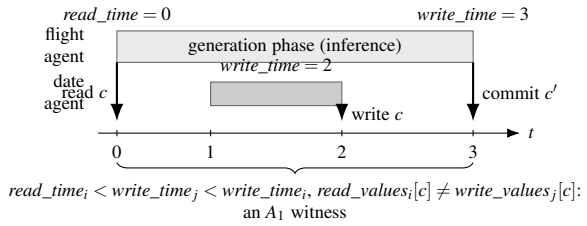


Fig. 1. The read–generate–commit window. Logical time is the length of the operation log. Operation i (flight agent) reads c at $read_time_i = 0$; operation j (date agent) commits a different value to c at $write_time_j = 2$, inside i's window; i commits at $write_time_i = 3$ grounded in the superseded read. The L_1 discipline re-validates the read set at $write_time_i$ and discards the generation.

in which contention is designed in (parallel fan-out over a shared store, several agents acting for one user, a registry mutated while plans are in flight), and the contribution is not that the anomalies are common: it is a catalog with mechanized definitions, disciplines priced per unit of sound work, and an account of what each leaves behind.

1.2 Why existing theory does not operationalize these failures

Hardware models [5], [6] presuppose bounded latency and static access sets; database isolation theory [7]–[9] supplies the anomaly-by-anomaly method we follow but holds the read set under lock or snapshot for the transaction's lifetime; replicated-storage consistency [10] treats operations as discrete events with summarizable signatures. The agent regime has unbounded generation latency, a mutable tool registry, and irreversible effects, so the cascading-abort machinery of database recovery, which assumes effects can be undone, is exactly what fails.

1.3 Contributions

We claim no new concurrency theory. Each anomaly below is a classical one, and we say which. The contribution is the operational port of four of them to agent runtimes, its mechanization at stated assurance levels, and an evaluation that measures the gap between each predicate and the harm it tracks—including the part of the harm that is not a concurrency anomaly at all.

(C1) A catalog with classical names, and what it leaves out (Section 3). Four history predicates in TLA$^+$—stale generation (A_1), phantom tool (A_2), causal cascade (A_3), tool-effect reordering (A_6)—each with a TLC witness and its classical counterpart: a failed backward validation [4], a dangling capability reference, recoverability with externalization as the commit point [16], and order preservation of external effects. Theorem 1 (TLAPS, 60 obligations) places A_1-freedom among the classical classes exactly, as a conditional guarantee whose hypotheses (per-agent non-overlap, read-before-commit, faithful records) are stated, checked on every committed record, and violated by one deployed construct we name. Two predicates stand outside the catalog, each for a stated reason. The *residue predicate R*: an irreversible effect is out while ordinary later writes have revised the state it was derived from; not an anomaly—it fires in correct sequential executions—but the harm no commit-time discipline reaches, decided on the records by argument provenance, and on the live study A_1 and R partition the outcome column (Section 3.6). And the *duplication predicate D*: one node's irreversible effect is out twice, the shape a deployed resumption path produces; not a property of the window but of the executor's replay semantics, stated with its witness and the guard that excludes it (Section 3.7).

(C2) A lattice, realized at stated bounds (Section 4). The 2^4 exclusion lattice is trivial; what is not is that every point is inhabited by a checked runtime configuration (64 TLC runs, no mismatch, at two agents, two cells, two operations and, for the safety half, two values), that one chain $L_0 \subsetneq \cdots \subsetneq L_4$ has a verified realizing runtime at every level, and that the basis ledger that answers R composes with every point without disturbing its verdict (160 further runs).

(C3) Verified disciplines, verified detectors, and exactly which bytes were measured (Section 5). Under two enumerated axioms and three enumerated stubs, with no `assume` or `admit`: detectors sound and complete against their specifications, two concurrent L_1 stores proved window-free under a verified reader–writer lock, and L_2 (output commit), L_3 (commit-order sequencing) and L_4 (validation at dispatch) runtimes whose verified files are, byte for byte, the files the runtime compiles (a gate checks the identity); the L_1, L_2 and L_4 bytes are the ones measured and the L_3 replay through its bytes is **[pending: step 15]**. The A_1 verdict of the published tables was taken by a hand-written port gated against the verified predicate on every cell; the verified detector is now compiled into the scorer and the rescoring of every cell through it is **[pending: runner step 14]**. Table 2 labels every claim with its assurance level (checked model, verified decision procedure, verified bytes, unverified port, open) and names each correspondence between TLA$^+$ definition, Verus restatement, executed code and scorer, with its hypothesis and the gate that checks it on the data. Of 371 obligations, 236 bear a deployed or measured artifact and 135 are scaffolding (supplement § S); the count is an inventory, not a result.

(C4) An evaluation scored on outcomes, not flags, with its own confounds measured (Section 6). For each discipline we report the anomaly it excludes, the harm that remains, and the price: on the live LangGraph study the L_1 residue is R in 2–63% of sessions at the 150 ms offset across two runs and three API families, decided on the records; the basis ledger with a compensator removes it on the store (booking $\neq$ final $0/100$ on all three families (5, 45, 53 obligations, all discharged)), and what that is worth in a world with a downstream consumer and a compensator that can fail is the measurement Section 6.2 designs and marks pending (Section 6.2); on 1,000 seeded cascades per depth, output commit removes exposure exactly when the review precedes the release and refuses the retraction otherwise; per sound committed operation, snapshot isolation costs $+0.4$–11.1% and pessimistic locking $+1.2$–97% in tokens. Where the design itself limits what a difference can mean—arms run as sequential blocks, a wall-clock comparison across cells—we quantify the confound on the receipts and say which comparisons it voids.

(C5) Where the preconditions occur (Section 6.9). A census of 98 public LangGraph repositories (407 graph sites) finds no confirmed co-scheduled reader and writer of a last-value channel (eight sites unresolved; a bracket of none to about half)—a negative result for A_1's structural precondition, which we report as one—while a released tool executor dispatches a model-emitted, order-dependent pipeline concurrently on $30/30$ turns of one backbone and never on another, which is the case for A_6.

What this paper does not establish. It does not establish a production prevalence for any anomaly: every occurrence figure is a race our harness opened or a rate on our own workloads, and the census measures how public code is written, not how often it runs. It does not verify the instrumentation or the Python harnesses (trust

base: Section 5.7), and the refinement of the deployed concurrent stores to their abstract machines is open. And a verified arm's zero is a theorem executing, not evidence, so the evaluation leads with costs and with counts that read no runtime flag.

2 RUNTIME MODEL

A system consists of a finite set of agents A, a shared memory M mapping cells to values with a distinguished sentinel NULL, and a shared registry R of available tools. An agent executes a sequence of *operations*, each in three phases: a *read* phase that captures the values of a chosen subset of cells (the operation's *read_set*) together with the registry contents (*read_registry*), stamping the read with the current log length as *read_time*; a *generation* phase, dominated by inference latency and not treated as instantaneous; and a *write* phase that atomically appends a record to the log, installing the planned writes (*write_set*, *write_values*), the selected tool (*planned_tool*) and the registry at commit (*write_registry*), stamped *write_time*. The log length is a logical clock [13]; a history h is the log, $h \in \mathrm{Seq}(\mathit{OpRecord})$. The specification is `Memory.tla`.

Store axiom. A read returns the latest committed value at or before its read time. TLC confirms this and the two hypotheses below as invariants of `Memory.tla` over all 2,961,434 reachable states at the checked bounds (Section 3.1).

Per-agent non-overlap; read before commit. Two operations of one agent do not overlap in $[\mathit{read_time}, \mathit{write_time}]$; every operation reads strictly before it commits. Both are invariants of the model, and both are load-bearing for Theorem 1 and for the detector transcription of Section 5.1. A framework that runs one node as several parallel instances under one name (LangGraph's `Send` fan-out) violates the first and is outside the model; Section 6.9 counts how often that shape appears in public code.

Determinism is not assumed by the theorems. Every mechanized result ranges over recorded histories with write values free. Under sampling, a value mismatch need not change the downstream decision, so the A_1 detector is a sound candidate screen that over-reports by a factor Section 6.8 measures. Durable-execution engines take the same stance [35]: replay is deterministic because every non-deterministic step's result is recorded, not because the step is.

Atomic commit is at the record level. External effects are outside the store and are governed separately: their order by A_6 and L_3, their release relative to a still-retractable basis by A_3 and L_2. At-most-once externalization is a hypothesis of this model; it is stated as the predicate D of Section 3.7, checked on every committed record (0 duplicate emissions among 4,500 externalized effects), and violated by one deployed resumption path we reproduce.

No replication; no one runtime. The memory is one logical store (split view under replication, A_4, is formalized separately in supplement § J and plays no role in the lattice), and the model derives from no one runtime: LangGraph is driven through it live (Section 6.1); three others are placed informally (supplement § D).

3 THE ANOMALY CATALOG

Four anomaly predicates over histories are formalized in TLA$^+$ (`Anomalies.tla`); each has a TLC witness at $|A|$=2, $|\mathit{Cells}| \le 2$, $\mathit{MaxOps} \le 4$, reproduced by the artifact's `reproduce.sh` and reproduced independently for this version. Table 1 names each predicate's classical counterpart and the regime feature that forces the port. The numbering (A_1, A_2, A_3, A_6) is kept from the public artifact; an earlier A_5 was subsumed by A_1. Section 3.6 then defines, outside the catalog, the predicate for what the four leave behind.

TABLE 1
Each cataloged predicate, its classical original, and what the agent regime changes. A_4 (split view) needs replication and is outside the single-store model.

Predicate	Classical condition	What the port changes
A_1 stale generation	failed backward validation [4]; its absence is commit-order read consistency (Theorem 1)	the read phase is an inference call: unbounded, unlocked, not cheaply re-validated
A_2 phantom tool	dangling capability reference [15]	the registry is mutable state with no relational analogue; the call reaches whatever is live at dispatch
A_3 causal cascade	recoverability, externalization in the role of commit [16]	effects are irreversible, so the dependent must be *held*, not aborted after the fact
A_6 effect reordering	order preservation of external effects (2PC, write buffering)	a batch the model declared parallelizable is dispatched concurrently; completion order is the commit order
R (residue, Section 3.6; not an anomaly)	view maintenance [68], with the view outside the system; why-provenance [67] for the basis	the effect is irreversible and its basis is revisable, so the window after commit never closes; only an obligation can be guaranteed (the remark of Section 3.6)

3.1 A_1: stale generation

Definition 1 (Stale generation)**.** A history h exhibits *stale generation* when there exist $i \neq j$ with $h[i].\mathit{agent} \neq h[j].\mathit{agent}$ and $c \in h[i].\mathit{read_set} \cap h[j].\mathit{write_set}$ such that

$$h[i].\mathit{read_time} < h[j].\mathit{write_time} < h[i].\mathit{write_time}$$
$$\text{and} \quad h[i].\mathit{read_values}[c] \neq h[j].\mathit{write_values}[c].$$

Witness. TLC finds a five-state counterexample: a_2 reads $c_1 =$ NULL at $\mathit{read_time} = 0$; a_1 commits $c_1 = v_1$ at $\mathit{write_time} = 1$; a_2 commits at $\mathit{write_time} = 2$ with $\mathit{read_values}[c_1] =$ NULL.

Classical placement. The minimal witness is a single read–write antidependency from i to j, serializable in the order $i; j$, and none of Adya's proscribed phenomena [8]; TLC exhibits such a history (claim `A1OnlyOnNonSerializable`, violated as expected). A_1 is therefore not an isolation anomaly in the classical sense. Its *absence* is nevertheless a classical correctness class, and we state which one at the level at which the theorem holds.

Definition 2 (Commit-order read consistency)**.** A history is *commit-order read consistent* when every operation read, for every cell in its read set, exactly the value it would have read had it executed atomically at its own commit point: for all i and $c \in h[i].\mathit{read_set}$, $h[i].\mathit{read_values}[c]$ is the value of the latest write to c with $\mathit{write_time} < h[i].\mathit{write_time}$, or NULL if there is none.

Writes are installed in commit order in any case, so Definition 2 is value-level equivalence, on the reads, to the serial execution in commit order. It is the value-level analogue of Weikum and Vossen's commit-order-preserving serializability [3] and not that condition itself, which is conflict-based; under value-unique writes the two coincide on reads (view equivalence [24]).

Theorem 1 (A_1-freedom implies commit-order read consistency)**.** *Let h satisfy the store axiom, read-before-commit and per-agent non-overlap. If h has no A_1 witness, then h is commit-order read consistent.*

The proof (`CommitOrder.tla`; TLAPS, 60 obligations, no omitted step) is Kung and Robinson's backward-validation argument run against our definitions: if some operation's read of c disagrees with the latest write to c before its commit, that write lies inside the operation's window, was made by another agent (one agent's operations do not overlap), and wrote a different value—an A_1 witness. Fifteen TLC verdicts (`check_commitorder.sh`) fix what the statement says, and all fifteen reproduce: over all 35,659 histories of length at most three the implication holds; it is not vacuous; it fails when either droppable hypothesis is removed; the relational definitions equal `Memory.tla`'s and a literal serial replay; the three hypotheses are invariants of the operational model over 2,961,434 reachable states; and the converse fails in exactly one shape—a value overwritten and then restored inside the window fires A_1 although the history is commit-order read consistent. The predicates nest strictly:

$$\neg\text{CORC} \implies A_1 \implies \text{validation fails.}$$

Reach. The theorem is a conditional guarantee over faithful histories that satisfy its three hypotheses; it says nothing about serializability of an application, about effects, about reads the instrumentation did not declare, or about a runtime that violates per-agent non-overlap. One deployed construct does: LangGraph's `Send` fan-out runs several instances under one agent name and is outside the model (Section 2). On the committed data both droppable hypotheses hold—0 same-agent overlapping windows and 0 reads not before their commit in 36,036 records over 10,488 traces (`hypothesis_gates.py`, a gate that fails on the first violation)—and a runtime can enforce the first by refusing a second operation of an agent whose window is open. The converse shape is a false positive of L_1, priced in discarded generations; on the live records it occurs in 0 of 710 A_1 witness pairs. Two corollaries are mechanized with the theorem. The classical lost update (P4 of Berenson et al. [7]) is an A_1 witness in which the stale reader also writes the cell it read, so L_1 excludes it. A *blind* overwrite—a write by an operation that never read the cell—is not an anomaly in isolation theory and is outside the catalog; it matters in Section 6.9, because the one in-the-wild bug we reproduce is of that kind, and in Section 6.1, because a revision that lands *after* the reader's commit is of that kind too.

3.2 A_2: phantom tool

Definition 3 (Phantom tool)**.** h exhibits a *phantom tool* when for some i,

$$h[i].\mathit{planned_tool} \neq \text{NULL},$$
$$h[i].\mathit{planned_tool} \in h[i].\mathit{read_registry},$$
$$h[i].\mathit{planned_tool} \notin h[i].\mathit{write_registry}.$$

An agent selects a tool from the registry it read; the registry mutates during generation; the commit emits a call to a capability that no longer exists. TLC's witness has four states. *Tool validity*, canonically, is membership of the (identifier, signature) pair: a tool is the same tool while both are unchanged. Definition 3 is stated over identifiers, the TLA$^+$ registry being a set of them; the Verus restatement of Section 5.4 maps identifiers to signatures and fires additionally when a tool is re-signed under its old name. The two coincide under the encoding the executable dispatcher uses, in which re-signing a tool is removal of the old pair and insertion of a fresh one, so that a re-signed tool is a removed tool to Definition 3; the scorer and the L_4 dispatcher decide the pair form, and Table 2 records the correspondence as an encoding, not a proof. A tool the agent names that was never in *read_registry* (a hallucinated call) is not A_2 and not in the catalog.

3.3 A_3: causal cascade

When an operation is retracted in a compensating (saga-style) runtime, any operation that read a value it produced is grounded on a basis no surviving commit supports. The classical remedy, cascading abort, flags the dependent aborted. In the agent regime that remedy fails in a specific way: if the dependent's tool effects have already been issued, the flag changes nothing that reached the world. The cataloged predicate is therefore stated over externalization.

Definition 4 (Causal cascade)**.** Let each record carry *aborted* and *externalized* flags and a predecessor set *preds* (the operations whose committed writes it observed, transitively closed). h exhibits a *causal cascade* when for some j, p:

$$h[j].\mathit{externalized} \wedge p \in h[j].\mathit{preds} \wedge h[p].\mathit{aborted}.$$

The surviving-dependent form, $\neg h[j].\mathit{aborted} \wedge p \in h[j].\mathit{preds} \wedge h[p].\mathit{aborted}$, is kept beside it as CASCADEUNPROPAGATED; a cascading abort falsifies that form by flagging j after j's effects are out, and Section 6.4 measures the separation on runnable arms.

Prevention is output commit, and output commit has a residue. Under Definition 4 a runtime must hold an operation's effects until every operation in its closure has released its own, and must refuse to retract an operation whose effects are out. The first clause is prevention. The second keeps the predicate false by refusing to set the flag it reads, and we do not count that as prevention: a refused retraction is a basis someone wished to withdraw after release, the ordinary rule of recoverability that a committed transaction cannot abort, and every measurement in Section 6.4 counts its residue beside the zero.

What the detector decides. A trace without provenance fields cannot decide Definition 4. What it can decide is an *unsupported read*—a committed read of a value that no surviving committed write produced at or before the read. The verified `detect_a3` decides exactly that screen, and its relation to Definition 4 is five mechanized facts (supplement § G): it is not sound in general (a value collision hides the aborted writer), it is sound under value-unique writes, the hypothesis black-box isolation checkers also need [30], [31], it holds along chains, it is not complete, and it is blind to relabeled effects. We therefore claim Definition 4 only where the hypothesis holds, and check it: value-unique writes hold by construction in the synthetic cascades (distinct value ranges per writer) and in all 600 live replay sessions (0 collisions), the two data sets the detector scores; they fail in 126 cells of the pilot and occurrence-study traces, where only A_1 is scored. A recorder that stamps each written value with its writer's operation identifier makes the hypothesis a system invariant.

3.4 A_6: tool-effect reordering

Each record additionally carries an issuance order *io* and a commit order *co* over its external effects; *write_set* and *write_values* derive from *co*.

Definition 5 (Tool-effect reordering)**.** *h* exhibits *tool-effect reordering* when for some *i*,

$$|h[i].io| \geq 2, \quad h[i].co \neq h[i].io,$$
$$h[i].co \text{ is a permutation of } h[i].io.$$

The minimal witness (three states, one agent, two cells) is benign over store cells, where writes to distinct cells commute; the predicate names an anomaly only under the reading in which each element of *io* is an external effect whose order an observer can see. It over-reports on commuting effects and, because it requires a permutation, is silent on dropped and duplicated effects; Section 8 exhibits the duplicated case in a deployed framework.

3.5 Snapshot insufficiency

L_1 is not a snapshot guarantee: "reads reflect memory at read time" is the store axiom of Theorem 1, holds on every reachable log, and TLC exhibits a history satisfying it on which A_1 fires (`MC_A1_struct`; supplement § B). The live instance is a runtime that pins a consistent snapshot per node—LangGraph's superstep—and has not thereby obtained L_1 (Section 6.1).

3.6 What the catalog leaves: the residue predicate

Every predicate above is decided at or before an operation's commit, and a discipline that excludes all four still leaves a harm the live study measures in 2–63% of sessions on the API families (Section 6.1): the external effect a commit released is irreversible, while the state it was derived from is ordinary revisable state that any later operation may overwrite. This is not a concurrency anomaly. It fires in correct sequential executions—book against the date known at commit, then be contradicted by a legitimate revision—and classical isolation has no name for it because a committed transaction's inputs are final by definition; the nearest notions are view maintenance [68] with the view outside the system, and the saga's compensation [17]. We define it because an evaluation scored on outcomes needs a predicate for the outcome's other half, and keep it outside the catalog and the lattice.

Each operation record carries a *basis*, the (cell, value) pairs its external effect was derived from, and an *obligation* flag. The basis is recovered by *argument provenance*: a read value that appears verbatim among the effect's arguments is part of its basis, and nothing is declared by the agent. This is why-provenance [67] restricted to copying, with that tradition's known limit: a value that reaches the effect through a computation leaves no basis, so the extractor under-reaches and never over-reports. In the model the basis is a nondeterministic subset of the read values, so every extractor is covered.

Definition 6 (Residue predicate)**.** *h* exhibits a *superseded-basis effect* (*R*; `NoA7` in the artifact) when for some *i*, $h[i].externalized$, $\neg h[i].obligation$, and for some $(c, v) \in h[i].basis$ the *latest* write to *c* committed after $h[i].write_time$ wrote a value other than *v*:

$$\exists j: \; c \in h[j].write_set \;\wedge\; h[j].write_time > h[i].write_time$$
$$\wedge\, h[j].write_values[c] \neq v$$
$$\wedge\, \forall k: \; (c \in h[k].write_set \wedge h[k].write_time > h[i].write_time)$$
$$\Rightarrow h[k].write_time \leq h[j].write_time.$$

A_1 and *R* partition "an effect is out on a basis the state no longer holds" by whether the superseding write committed inside the operation's window or after its commit; a value overwritten and then restored fires neither, and *R* carries no agent conjunct because the obligation is owed whoever supersedes. On the live data the partition is exact (Table 3): $A_1 + R = 100$ in every unguarded cell, and under L_1 the A_1 column is empty and the residue is entirely *R*. The identity is not evidence for the extractor: on a workload that revises once per session and copies the date verbatim into the booking it holds whenever the extractor recovers the basis at all, and it recovers 4,500/4,500 because the booking tool takes the date as a structured argument. We keep it as a gate (`a7_rescore --check`), and the extractor's blind spot is stated in Section 8. TLC's witness has five states and is not an A_1 witness: an operation reads $c_1 = \text{NULL}$ and commits an effect with basis $\{(c_1, \text{NULL})\}$, released at commit; a later operation commits $c_1 = v_1$.

What remains after release (a remark, not a result). Under the *open-world hypothesis*—the store accepts, at any time after an effect *e* with basis *B* is released, a write to a cell of *B* by an operation that does not depend on *e*—two things are immediate and we state them only to fix what a discipline can promise. (i) Some execution supersedes *B* while *e* is out, because the write is admitted after a release that cannot be recalled. (ii) If obligations are never cleared, $\neg R$ holds in every reachable state iff, in every execution, *e*'s obligation is set in the same step as, or before, every step that completes the other conjuncts of Definition 6 (the superseding commit for a released effect; the release for an effect superseded while held), because Definition 6 is "superseded and not owed" and a monotone flag set by the first such step stays set. So under the hypothesis a discipline can promise not a current basis but an obligation registered atomically with the step that completes the witness, which the ledger of Section 5.5 does at both steps. Dropping the hypothesis is possible and is not free: freezing the cells of *B* until the effect is acknowledged is a lock held past commit, with the pessimistic column of Table 6 as its price floor; output commit (Section 3.3) holds effects only until their *causal* basis is externalized, a finite condition. What a registered obligation buys in the world—a rebooking, a cancellation, a human notification—is a property of the compensator and is measured, not proved (Sections 6.1 and 6.2).

3.7 What the model assumes about effects: at-most-once, as a predicate

The model externalizes an operation's effects once, at commit. LangGraph's `interrupt` resumes a node by re-executing it from its start, so an irreversible effect issued *before* the gate is emitted again after it, with different arguments when the shared value was revised during the gate (Section 6.9; 2 emissions of one pre-gate effect in the probe). Rather than record this as a limitation we state the hypothesis as a predicate over the effect stream: *D* holds when two emissions carry the same node's effect, and $D^{\neq}$ when they also differ in their arguments. A five-action TLA$^+$ module (`Duplication.tla`: issue, gate, resume-from-start, finish, revise) reaches *D* in 5 steps and $D^{\neq}$ in 6, and with an idempotency key per (node, effect) TLC finds neither over 1,714 states exhaustively, with exactly one effect out per finished node. *D* is kept outside the catalog and the lattice like *R*: its carrier, the effect stream, is disjoint from the four disciplines', which therefore neither create nor remove it. On the committed records 0 of 4,500 externalized effects were emitted twice (`hypothesis_gates.py`, H5).

4 THE LATTICE AND ONE CHAIN THROUGH IT

A consistency model is a predicate over histories, characterized by the set of anomalies it excludes [8]. With $\mathscr{A} = \{A_1, A_2, A_3, A_6\}$ the design space is the Boolean lattice $\langle 2^{\mathscr{A}}, \subseteq \rangle$: sixteen points, bottom $\emptyset$ admitting everything, top $\mathscr{A}$ admitting nothing (drawn in supplement § L). We name five points on one maximal chain,

$$L_0 \equiv \emptyset,\ L_1 \equiv \{A_1\},\ L_2 \equiv \{A_1, A_3\},\ L_3 \equiv \{A_1, A_3, A_6\},\ L_4 \equiv \mathscr{A},$$

chosen on operational grounds (A_1 first because it is the basic read–generate–commit failure; A_2 last because registry stability across the operation lifetime is the costliest single requirement); the other twenty-three linearizations are equally valid and the lattice, not the chain, is primary. The residue predicate R is not a generator: it is not an anomaly, and its answer, the basis ledger ℓ of Section 5.5, composes with any point.

4.1 What is and is not a result

The chain's inclusions are definitional and its strictness needs one witness per step; neither is a result. What requires work is *realizability*: a runtime configuration that excludes exactly each point's anomalies, and for the five named points a verified realizing runtime—established here by bounded model checking at two agents, two cells and two operations (three for A_3), with the value domain of one for the witness half and two for the safety half, and claimed at exactly those bounds. Histories of that length exercise every predicate's minimal witness and nothing longer; the unbounded statement exists only for the top point, as the Verus product of Section 5.6.

4.2 All sixteen points, mechanically; the ledger composes

`Guarded.tla` extends the runtime with four commit-time disciplines, each enabled by a Boolean constant and each acting on its own carrier: G_1, read-set validation (an operation whose read set was overwritten after its read may not commit); G_2, registry validation (a planned tool no longer in the registry may not be dispatched); G_3, causal tracking with output commit (an operation records the closure of committed writers whose values it read, may not commit while any is aborted, externalizes only once its closure has externalized, and once externalized is irrevocable; a retraction cascades to every unexternalized dependent); G_6, commit-order sequencing (effects externalize in issuance order). The carriers are disjoint—read set and write times; registry and planned tool; closure and abort flags; issuance and commit orders—so enabling one guard neither creates nor removes another anomaly, and the matrix confirms it on every combination.

For each of the sixteen guard sets S and each anomaly a, TLC checks $R(S) \models \neg a$: for $a \in S$ the invariant must hold exhaustively, for $a \notin S$ it must be violated. All 64 runs match (`lattice16.sh`; $|A|$=2, $|Cells|$=2, $|Values|$=1, $MaxOps$=2, symmetry on agents and cells; the 32 safety runs are exhaustive over 380,920–2,015,279 distinct states). Because CAUSALCASCADE ranges over flags and predecessor sets and never over cells, the sixteen NOA3 points are rechecked at $MaxOps$=3 with one cell, where a transitive cascade first becomes reachable: 16/16 match. A single-value domain makes Definition 1's value conjunct vacuous on non-null reads; the safety half re-run at $|Values|$=2 stays safe in all 32 cells, and a targeted check shows the non-null-read witness class needs both a second value *and* a third operation (supplement § L); the two-value safety half is re-run on the current model (all 32 safety runs SAFE, 2.4–17.3M states). Every point is thus inhabited by a runtime that prevents exactly its avoidance set, at these bounds; the Verus product of the L_2, L_3 and L_4 models (Section 5.6) mechanizes the top point without a bound.

The ledger composes. `Guarded5.tla` adds a fifth constant G_7, the basis ledger of Section 5.5, which refuses nothing and writes only the basis and obligation fields. `lattice32.sh` runs all 160 combinations of the five constants against the four anomalies and R at the same bounds. The 64 anomaly cells with G_7 on return the verdicts of `lattice16.sh` one for one, so the ledger disturbs no point of the lattice; R is reached without G_7 in a five-state trace at every point and excluded with G_7 at every point (exhaustive; 5,213,012 distinct states at the bottom point, 9,688,601 with output commit, where a held effect can be superseded before its release). All 160 runs match their expectation (0 mismatches); the exhaustive runs range over 1,803,848–9,688,601 distinct states, and the sixty-four commit-time cells with G_7 off return the verdicts of `lattice16.sh` one for one.

5 MECHANIZATION

Three tools carry the development, at assurance levels Table 2 labels claim by claim. TLC checks the witnesses, the lattice and ledger matrices and the fifteen Theorem 1 verdicts (bounded, exhaustive within bounds). TLAPS proves Theorem 1 (60 obligations), a coherence check of the chain definitions (`Hierarchy.tla`, 15) and a same-agent exclusion lemma (`A1LowerBound.tla`, 28); none is a substantive result except the first. Verus [19] carries the substantive mechanization: 371 obligations (392 counting four helper files), zero errors, no `assume` or `admit` in any proof body, regenerated by `verus_count.sh` against a pinned build (`verus-version.txt`; a newer verifier makes proof files stop compiling rather than fail, which the counter reports as such). Of these, 236 bear a deployed or measured artifact's safety claim and 135 are scaffolding (superseded refinements, the A_4 model, the model-only Verus mirror of `Guarded.tla`), verified but not load-bearing; supplement § S inventories every file.

5.1 Verified detectors, and one transcription gap

The four detectors are verified sound *and* complete against Verus `spec` restatements of the TLA$^+$ predicates (24 obligations). `detect_a1` is a two-sided equivalence whose completeness half strengthens each of three nested loop invariants to carry "no witness in the prefix searched." `detect_a2` and `detect_a6` are single-record equivalences; `detect_a3` is exact for the flat-trace residue of Section 3.3.

The restatement is hand-written and checked by inspection, and inspection found a gap we state rather than hide. The Verus `OpRecord` carries no agent field, so its A_1 predicate omits the different-agent conjunct of Definition 1; and it decides "no witness" when a read value is absent, where the TLA$^+$ compares against NULL. Neither matters on the histories the model admits, and we say why.

Lemma 1 (Same-agent exclusion)**.** *Under per-agent non-overlap and read-before-commit, if* $c \in h[i].read_set \cap h[k].write_set$ *and* $h[i].read_time < h[k].write_time < h[i].write_time$, *then* $h[i].agent \neq h[k].agent$.

The lemma is step $\langle 2 \rangle 2$ of the TLAPS proof of Theorem 1 and the content of `A1LowerBound.tla`. It makes the Verus predicate and Definition 1 coincide on every history satisfying the

TABLE 2
Every claim at its assurance level. *Model*: checked by TLC within bounds; *proof*: TLAPS or Verus, no `assume`/`admit`; *bytes*: the verified code is the code measured; *port*: unverified code gated against a verified artifact on the committed data; *open*: stated, not established. Correspondences name the hypothesis under which two formalizations agree and the gate (`harness/macaudit/`) that checks it.

Claim	Definition	Proof / check	Executed by	Correspondence, hypothesis, gate; status
Anomaly witnesses, lattice realizability	TLA$^+$	TLC, $\|A\|$=2, ≤ 2 cells, ≤ 2 values, MaxOps ≤ 4 (witnesses), ≤ 3 (matrix)	—	**model**: bounded; 64+16+32 two-value safety runs
Theorem 1	TLA$^+$	TLAPS 60	—	**proof**; hypotheses H1–H3 are model invariants (TLC) and H1 is checked on all 36,036 committed records (`hypothesis_gates`: 0 violations)
`detect_a1` sound & complete	Verus spec	Verus	scorer: the verified bytes (`detect_a1_exec.rs`) behind an interning wrapper	**proof** against the restatement; restatement = Definition 1 under Lemma 1 (TLAPS step); **port** on the published cells, gated on every cell (`predicate_matrix_a1`); rescoring through the verified bytes **[pending: step 14]**
`detect_a2`	Verus spec (id, signature)	Verus	L_4 dispatcher (bytes); scorer (port)	**proof** of the detector, **port** in the scorer; Definition 3 (identifiers) coincides under the re-sign-as-replace encoding; **encoding stated, not proved**
`detect_a3`	Verus spec (unsupported read)	Verus	scorer (port)	**proof** for the screen, **port** in the scorer; = Definition 4 under value-unique writes, which hold on every scored trace (`hypothesis_gates`: 600 sessions, 0 collisions)
`detect_a6`	Verus spec	Verus	scorer (port)	**proof** of the detector, **port** in the scorer; single-record equivalence to Definition 5
L_1 stores window-free	Verus	Verus (lock predicate)	pilot (bytes); live *verified* arm (bytes via bridge); *validated* arm (application layer)	**bytes** in the pilot and the verified arm; **port** in the validated arm; refinement to the abstract machine **open**
L_2 output commit	Verus	Verus	`l2_exec` (bytes)	**bytes**; sequential object, caller serializes
L_3 sequencing	Verus	Verus	twin (inspection); `l3_exec` behind a bridge **[pending: step 15]**	**port**
L_4 validation at dispatch	Verus	Verus	`l4_exec` (bytes)	**bytes**
R on the live records	Definition 6	—	`a7_rescore` (Python)	**port**, unverified; independent of the outcome column; extractor coverage 4,500/4,500 on this workload (no reference set: coverage, not recall)
Basis ledger excludes R	TLA$^+$ G_7; Verus model	TLC 160 runs; Verus verified (7 obligations)	probe 303 ledger arm (Python, over the application-layer L_1)	**model** and **proof**; executable ledger is a **port** (harness code); what a discharged obligation is worth in a world: measured (Section 6.2)
D (at-most-once) excluded by an idempotency key	TLA$^+$	TLC: witness, exhaustive with the key	—	**model**: bounded (1,714 states); on the records 0/4,500 duplicates (`hypothesis_gates`, H5)

model's invariants; on a history that violates non-overlap the Verus predicate is strictly stronger—it over-reports, the safe direction for a detector. The instrumentation records a value for every read cell, so the absent-value case does not arise: across all 36,036 committed operation records there is no read cell without a value and 0 same-agent overlapping windows (`hypothesis_gates.py --check`).

Which bytes score A_1. Agreement of three transcriptions on committed data is testing, not equivalence, and the earlier version of this paper reported tables scored by a hand-written port with such a gate. The scorer now takes its A_1 verdict from `detect_a1` itself: the verified exec-mode file (`lib_detect_a1_exec.rs`, 9 obligations, sound and complete against `is_a1_witness`, the same conjuncts as the gated restatement `a1_witness` of `lib_detector_equivalence.rs` over (cell, value) pairs in place of a set and a map; their agreement is checked by inspection and on every cell by the same gate) is compiled by plain cargo into the runtime crate byte-identical to the verified source, and a 60-line wrapper interns cell names and values injectively to the integers the verified predicate ranges over, drops a duplicated declared cell (the precondition `wf_hist`) and encodes a read cell without a value as a sentinel no record can carry; the wrapper is the one unverified piece between the verified bytes and a string-valued record, and it is trust-base item (xii). The port is kept beside it and the binary refuses a trace on which the two disagree. The rescoring of every published cell through the verified bytes is **[pending: runner step 14]**; until its receipt is committed the tables stand on the gated port.

5.2 L_1: two concurrent stores whose lock is verified, not assumed

Three abstract state machines—pessimistic locking, serializable snapshot isolation (SSI), and default snapshot isolation with its no-write bypass—are proved A_1-free under sequential interleaving (40 obligations; default-SI conditionally, on workloads with no read-only commit, which is the residual Section 6.3 measures). The deployed stores do not rest on these: each is an exec-mode store whose only access path is `vstd::rwlock::RwLock`, the reader–writer lock implemented and verified inside the Verus standard library, carrying the store's invariant as the lock predicate (`lib_si_concurrent.rs`, 18; `lib_pess_concurrent.rs`, 31; no axiom, no `external_body`). The invariant entails the absence of any stale-generation window in the store's own record stream, under any interleaving of threads. Theorem L1j (`lib_si_projection.rs`, 3) transports that guarantee to the detector's history for *faithful* emitters—one `OpRecord` per store record, cells a subset of the record's. The default-SI `tick` path is the standing counterexample to faithfulness and is exactly the 5%/8% residual of Table 4. Four earlier refinements (86 obligations, two axioms) relate the abstract machines to the representations shipped *before* the verified-lock rebuild and bear no deployed claim; refining the two concurrent stores to the abstract machines is the open proof step (a bounded simulation over 506,880 transitions finds no counterexample; supplement § H).

5.3 L_2: output commit

The L_2 model (`lib_l2_safety.rs`, 33) carries per transaction a predecessor set recorded as a causal closure at read time. A commit is valid iff the read set is fresh against the committed store and every predecessor is committed and unaborted; an abort cascades to every transaction whose closure holds the aborter; effects leave by a separate `externalize` step enabled only once the closure has externalized; an externalized transaction cannot abort. Theorem L_2h: no state satisfying the inductive invariant *inv_output_commit* contains a witness of Definition 4 (`lemma_l2_reachable_no_a3`), under arbitrary interleaving of the six steps; the closure invariant makes the one-level cascade provably sufficient for the transitive case. Theorem L_2i: every committed read has a surviving producer of exactly its value, and (temporal strengthening) that producer committed no later than the read. Theorem L_2j (`lib_l2_projection.rs`, 3): a faithful emission of an L_2-supported state contains no residue witness, by a bridge that never refers to a read's producer and so cannot assume what it proves. The exec runtime (`lib_l2_exec.rs`, 73 end to end, 40 net of the re-included model) refines the model per transition with zero added axioms (its `u64` interning is natively injective); every mutating entry point checks its own guard and reports whether it acted, so the guarantee survives proof erasure under plain `cargo`, and the file compiled by the reference runtime is byte-identical.

5.4 L_3: sequencing, and L_4: validation at dispatch

Theorem L_3g (`lib_l3_sequencer.rs`, 5): a commit-order sequencer that externalizes effect k once effects $0..k$ have completed yields an externalization time monotone in issuance index for *every* completion schedule, hence no A_6, without forbidding concurrency; a reversed schedule exhibits A_6 unsequenced and none sequenced. The saga model (`lib_l3_safety.rs`, 6) is the strict-serialization special case and composes with L_2 on disjoint carriers. The exec sequencer (`lib_l3_exec.rs`, 7) is verified and compiled byte-identical into the runtime crate; the measurement of Section 6.5 published here ran a dependency-free twin, a gap the trust base records; the replay through the verified bytes behind a 70-line JSON bridge is **[pending: runner step 15]**.

Resolving a planned tool against a registry snapshot does not prevent A_2: a snapshot changes what an operation resolves, not the tool its call reaches (Theorem L_4d, a concrete execution). The L_4 model (`lib_l4_safety.rs`, 9) reads A_2 from a *dispatch record* and validates at dispatch—place the call only if the planned tool is still live with the pinned signature; registry churn interleaves arbitrarily and cannot create A_2 because A_2 is a property of the dispatch. The exec dispatcher (`lib_l4_exec.rs`, 11) refuses a revoked or re-signed tool and dispatches an untouched one, and Section 6.6 measures those bytes. Validation and dispatch are one atomic step of a registry the runtime owns; a remote tool server (MCP [20]) offers no such atomicity and the check-then-call gap there is narrowed, not closed.

5.5 The basis ledger

The ledger ℓ answers R and composes with any discipline; the live study runs it over the application-layer L_1 (Table 3; the arm over the verified store is **[pending: runner step 17]**). Its model (`lib_l5_ledger.rs`, 7 obligations, 0 errors) carries the store's committed values and, per effect, its basis map, an externalized flag and an obligation flag. Three steps: *register* commits an effect with its basis (released at once, or held under output commit; if released at once on a basis the store already disagrees with, the obligation is set at commit); *write* installs a value and marks, in the same step, every externalized effect whose basis holds that cell with a different value; *externalize* releases a held effect and marks it if its basis is stale by then. The invariant *inv_l5*—every externalized effect with a stale basis carries an obligation—is preserved by each step (the write step is the load-bearing case: the cell that became stale is the cell the step marked, and any other stale cell was stale before), and the ledger theorem: no state satisfying *inv_l5* contains a witness of Definition 6. The model's witness is the state form—an externalized, unowed effect whose basis the store now disagrees with—which contains Definition 6's (a latest post-commit writer that differs implies a current value that differs), so excluding it excludes the definition's witness and, in addition, an effect released on a basis already stale at commit. Non-vacuity in both directions: the unguarded write reaches R in two steps from an effect derived from an unwritten cell, and under the ledger the same write registers the obligation while a write that restores the value leaves no witness. The ledger refuses nothing; refusing to release a stale-basis effect, or holding it for a deadline, is a policy the executable runtime layers on top, and what a registered obligation achieves in the world is measured in Section 6.1. The model is verified (7 obligations) under the pinned build; its obligations are counted as scaffolding (135 with it) because the executable ledger of the live study is harness code, not these bytes. An exec ledger on the L_2/L_4 pattern is not in this version.

5.6 Composition

`lib_consistency_lattice.rs` takes the product of the L_2, L_3 and L_4 states over their disjoint carriers and proves that the conjunction of the three invariants excludes A_1 (image), A_3, A_6 and A_2 jointly, with three non-interference lemmas; 53 obligations, of which 48 are the re-verified component modules. The ledger's carrier (basis, obligation) is disjoint from all three, and adding it to the product is the same construction; it is not in this version.

5.7 Trust base

"Zero `assume`, zero `admit`" is a statement about proof bodies. What is trusted, in full: (i) Verus, its SMT backend and `vstd`, including `group_hash_axioms` for the `HashMap`-backed exec states; (ii) two axioms in the four superseded refinements (string injectivity, null sentinel) and (iii) three `external_body` stubs for a `parking_lot::Mutex`, neither bearing a deployed claim since the verified-lock rebuild; (iv) the hand restatement of the TLA$^+$ predicates in Verus, with the gap of Section 5.1 stated and gated; (v) the hand-written scorer that produced the tables, gated against the verified predicate on every committed cell; (vi) for L_3, the inspection-level correspondence between the exec artifact and the measured twin; (vii) the `pub` fields of the exec runtimes, which a caller can write around the API; (viii) the marshalling that flattens the version map into the verified validation gate, and the interning bijection and abort counter outside the verified store; (ix) the Python and Rust instrumentation that produces every `OpRecord`, including the read sets it declares. This item is the largest and we confront it rather than cite around it: a detector is as good as the read set it is handed; S-Bus [38], our own read-set reconstruction from HTTP traffic, measures 74% of reads on a SWE-bench workload as invisible to that surface, and nothing here would see them either. What can be measured, at the store boundary: whether

the keys a node read between its first read and its commit equal its declared read set (`hypothesis_gates.py`, H6; the field is recorded by the probes since this version and no committed run carries it yet, so H6 is implemented and **[pending: runner steps 17/18]**); what cannot: a value that reaches the model through prompt context, which neither instrument sees. (x) the provenance correspondence between the two formalizations of A_3, which agree only under value-unique writes (checked on every scored trace); (xi) in the live study's verified arm, the 100-line JSON bridge and the harness's interning of cells and values; (xii) the 60-line interning wrapper between the verified A_1 detector and a string-valued record (Section 5.1); (xiii) the 70-line bridge between the verified L_3 sequencer and the tool executor (Section 6.5). No safety-bearing proof invokes a writes-as-function-of-reads assumption, and the development carries no probabilistic obligation.

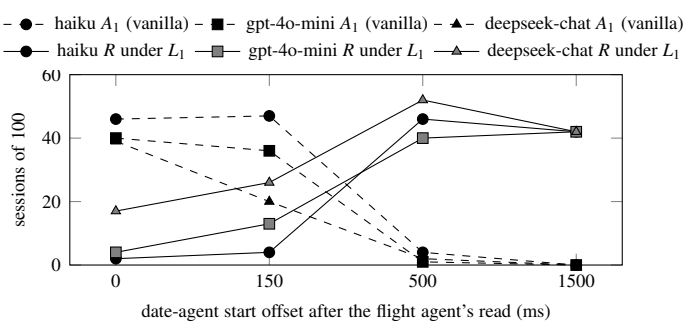


Fig. 2. Probe 303, offset sweep: the live A_1 rate without a discipline (dashed) and the residue R that read-set validation leaves (solid) as the date agent's start is delayed; revision probability 0.5, $n = 100$ per point. As the window closes the same revisions land after the commit: A_1 falls to 0 while R rises to the revision rate.

6 Evaluation

Three questions. **RQ1** For each discipline, what does it prevent, and what harm remains once it has? **RQ2** What does prevention cost, per unit of work the discipline actually delivered? **RQ3** Where do the structural preconditions of the anomalies occur in deployed code? A verified arm's zero is a theorem, so every zero below is reported beside a count that reads no runtime flag.

Provenance. Every table cell maps to a committed trace directory and a scorer in the artifact; `reproduce.sh` rescores all of them offline under an implementation of Definition 1 independent of the verified detector and the Rust port, and fails on any disagreement. The numbers in this section were re-derived that way for this version. Model-driven cells are one run each at the stated n; replicates differ by model sampling, so a regeneration reproduces the protocol and the intervals, not the sessions. Intervals are exact Clopper–Pearson unless stated.

6.1 RQ1 on a live runtime: what L_1 removes and what it leaves

The scenario of Section 1.1 runs on an unmodified LangGraph runtime (`langgraph` 1.2.0) with live models. Two compiled graphs share one `BaseStore`, the framework's cross-thread memory, subclassed only to stamp a logical clock at `get`/`put` under one lock; `BaseStore` offers no version or compare-and-set, so the framework as shipped cannot validate a read set. A flight agent reads the trip date, drafts a reservation over a model call and puts the booking; a date agent, started by the harness 150 ms after the flight agent's read, reads the date, asks its model for a one-week revision and puts it. Three modes: *vanilla*; *validated*, the L_1 discipline at the application layer (re-read before `put`, discard the generation and regenerate on change); and *sequential*, a control in which the date agent runs after the flight agent commits. 100 sessions per cell on three model families. Each session records the A_1 verdict, the regenerations, and the booking's and final trip dates (Table 3).

The window is open and the framework does not close it. On both API models the runtime committed the stale booking in every session in which the revision landed inside the window (60% and 91%), the detector fired with the exact temporal witness of Definition 1, and in 150 of the 152 firings across the three families the stale date reached the booking text; nothing in the framework blocked, validated or reported any of them.

What the rates are. The revision changed the value in $300/300$ sessions; whether it landed inside the window is the reviser's latency relative to the writer's plus the fixed offset. Behind a request-serializing local server the open-weights family's revision landed after the commit in $99/100$ sessions, the one firing being the session with the longest pinned interval (9.06 s): a property of the serving configuration, not of the model.

What L_1 removes, and what it does not. Read-set validation removed every firing ($0/300$) at one discarded generation per realized conflict (66 and 93 per 100 sessions, never two in one session, none where the race never realized). It did not make the booking agree with the final trip date: in 34 and 7 of 100 sessions the revision landed after the commit: the committed record is current at its commit point exactly as Theorem 1 says, and the booking is stale with respect to a state that did not yet exist. That residue is a post-commit supersession—the blind overwrite of Section 3.1, serializable in commit order, outside every isolation discipline—and only compensation, or holding the effect until its basis is final, reaches it. The *sequential* control, clean under every commit-time predicate, delivers the wrong booking in $100/100$ sessions for the same reason; reporting the predicate alone would have credited L_1 with a correctness it does not provide.

***R* decides the residue on the records.** Definition 6 names what is left, and the R column of Table 3 is decided on the emitted records alone: the basis of each booking is the date value in its arguments, and R fires in exactly the sessions whose booking disagrees with the final date and A_1 does not ($A_1 + R = 100$ in every unguarded cell; under L_1 the R column equals the residue; `a7_rescore.py --check`). The identity is between two independent computations (Section 3.6), and it holds here because the booking tool takes the date as a structured argument; a workload whose effects paraphrase their inputs would show a coverage below 4,500/4,500 and a smaller R column, never a larger one. Two further arms run the same harness on three API families (haiku, gpt-4o-mini and deepseek-chat, the last through its OpenAI-compatible endpoint). In the *verified* arm the L_1 decision is taken by the verified store through the bridge of Section 5.7: A_1 fires in $0/300$ sessions, and the residue is 2, 51 and 52 of 100 against 12, 51 and 63 for the application-layer arm in the same run. In the *ledger* arm a superseding put registers the obligation and a compensator issues a replacement booking: the outcome column is $0/100$ on all three families (5, 45 and 53 obligations registered, each discharged by one compensation generation), at the price of the discarded generations of L_1 plus one generation per obligation.

What a difference between arms can mean. The four arms of the

TABLE 3
Live cross-agent stale generation on an unmodified LangGraph runtime, n=100 per cell at a 150 ms race offset; the date agent revises in every session. A_1: Definition 1 on the emitted records. R: Definition 6 by argument provenance. *Booking ≠ final*: the harm, read off the store. *Regen.*: discarded generations. Modes: *validated* is L_1 at the application layer; *verified* takes the commit decision from the verified L_1 store through a JSON bridge; *ledger* adds the basis ledger and a rebooking compensator. The first three blocks' vanilla/validated/sequential rows are the committed September run; the verified, ledger and deepseek-chat rows are an October run of all four arms (its own vanilla/validated arms: $A_1 = 94, 44$; residue 12, 51), executed as four sequential blocks of 100 sessions (see the text on what a between-arm difference can mean). The ledger arm is the application-layer L_1 plus a harness ledger. Every R cell is re-derived from the records (`a7_rescore --check`, 36/36 probe-303 cells agree). In this run the harness ledger wrote no obligation record and registered the obligation only by firing the compensator, so R's 0 in the ledger rows is read off the compensation record and is definitional—it says the compensator ran—and only the outcome column measures anything; the probes now emit an explicit obligation record at the superseding put, so that in the replicated run R is decided from the registration itself, whether or not the compensation then succeeded.

Model	Mode	A_1 (95% CI)	R	Booking ≠ final	Regen.
gpt-4o-mini	vanilla	60/100 [49.7, 69.7]	40	100/100	0
	validated (L_1)	0/100 [0, 3.6]	34	34/100 [24.8, 44.2]	66
	verified (L_1, verified store)	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	51	51/100 [40.8, 61.1]	49
	ledger (L_1+ℓ)	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	0	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	55+45 (45/45 obl.)
	sequential	0/100 [0, 3.6]	100	100/100	0
claude-haiku-4-5	vanilla	91/100 [83.6, 95.8]	9	100/100	0
	validated (L_1)	0/100 [0, 3.6]	7	7/100 [2.9, 13.9]	93
	verified (L_1, verified store)	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	2	2/100 [0.2, 7.0]	98
	ledger (L_1+ℓ)	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	0	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	95+5 (5/5 obl.)
	sequential	0/100 [0, 3.6]	100	100/100	0
Llama-3.2 (local)	vanilla	1/100 [0.0, 5.4]	99	100/100	0
	validated (L_1)	0/100 [0, 3.6]	100	100/100	0
	sequential	0/100 [0, 3.6]	100	100/100	0
deepseek-chat	vanilla	45/100 [35.0, 55.3]	55	100/100 [96.4, 100.0]	0
	validated (L_1)	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	63	63/100 [52.8, 72.4]	37
	verified (L_1, verified store)	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	52	52/100 [41.8, 62.1]	48
	ledger (L_1+ℓ)	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	0	0/100 [0.0, 3.6]	47+53 (53/53 obl.)
Pinned interval, read to commit, s (mean; max): gpt-4o-mini 1.07; 3.79 haiku 1.21; 1.96 Llama 3.77; 9.06					

October run were executed as sequential blocks of 100 sessions, and the residue under an L_1 discipline is the share of sessions whose revision landed after the commit—a race between two provider latencies plus the fixed offset. A latency drift between two blocks therefore moves the residue without any change of discipline, and this design cannot tell the two apart. The data show the size of the effect: the two L_1 arms on haiku, the same discipline decided in two places, differ at 12 vs. 2 of 100 (Fisher exact $p = 0.010$), while on gpt-4o-mini and deepseek-chat they do not ($p = 1.000$, 0.152); the validated arm on gpt-4o-mini differs between the September and October runs at 34 vs. 51 ($p = 0.022$) and its vanilla A_1 rate at 60 vs. 44 ($p = 0.033$). We therefore attribute no between-arm residue difference in Table 3 to a discipline; what the table supports is the within-arm statement—L_1 in either place removes every A_1 firing and leaves a residue that is the revision rate split by timing—and the ledger's zero, which does not depend on where the revision lands. The attributable design interleaves the arms per session in a seeded order and repeats the protocol with fresh seeds. That run is **[pending: runner step 17: three interleaved runs per family, five arms including the ledger over the verified store]**; its receipts replace this paragraph's single-run comparison.

The offset sweep. Figure 2 varies the race instead of fixing it: the date agent starts 0, 150, 500 or 1,500 ms after the flight agent's read and revises in about half the sessions ($p = 0.5$), $n = 100$ per point on the three API families. Without a discipline A_1 fires in 39–46 of 100 sessions at 0 ms and in 0 at 1,500 ms, where every revision lands after the commit, while the booking is wrong in every revised session at every offset (44–51). Under L_1 the curve inverts: the residue is 2–17 at 0 ms and 42–52 at 500–1,500 ms, the discarded generations falling from 34–49 to 0. Predicate and residue are the two halves of one quantity, the revision rate, split by where the revision lands relative to the commit; which half a deployment sees is a property of its latencies, and the ledger is the only arm whose outcome does not depend on them. What the remark of Section 3.6 says must remain after release does remain under every commit-time discipline, and the ledger is the one arm that answers it.

Superstep. A second graph places a writer and a summarizer of one reducer-declared channel in one Pregel superstep [21]; the barrier hands both the snapshot at superstep entry, so in 300/300 sessions the summary names the destination the writer had changed: the snapshot-insufficiency shape of Section 3.5 observed live, reported as documented BSP semantics, not a rate (the census finds it in no public graph; under a completion clock Definition 1 fires in 42, 72, 26 of 100).

6.2 The ledger in a world: a consumer, a cancellation, a compensator that fails

The ledger arm's 0/100 is a statement about the final store: the compensator overwrote the booking cell, nothing read the first booking between its release and the compensation, the compensator could not fail, and the workload revised once. None of that is true of a world, so we measure the same discipline against one (probe 304): the booking is an irreversible effect in an external service that stays active until cancelled; a *consumer*—a downstream reader that sends the itinerary—reads the active bookings a uniform 0–1.5 s after the first release; the date agent revises *twice* (150 ms and +800 ms after the flight agent's read, exercising the ledger's re-arm path); and the world refuses a cancellation or a rebooking with probability 0.1 each, in which case the obligation stays registered and open and is retried at the next supersession. Three arms share every session's seed and run interleaved: L_1 alone; L_1 with the

TABLE 4
AutoGen pilot, A_1 firing rate by runtime and workload (run `20260913T0150Z`, n=100 per cell). *Complete & clean*: sessions with no A_1 witness in which every role that commits in the unguarded cell also commits here.

Runtime	edit-review	plan-execute	triage
Vanilla	100% [96.4, 100]	0% [0, 3.6]	48% [37.9, 58.2]
Pessimistic locking	0% [0, 3.6]	0% [0, 3.6]	0% [0, 3.6]
Snapshot isolation (default-SI)	5% [1.6, 11.3]	0% [0, 3.6]	8% [3.5, 15.2]
Complete & clean, vanilla / pess. / SI	0 / 1 / 0	99 / 100 / 99	52 / 3 / 45

ledger and a compensator that cancels the stale booking before rebooking; and the same without the cancellation, which is what the compensator of Table 3 does seen from the world. Scored at the end of each session in the world: sessions with an active booking whose date is not the final date (*world wrong*), with two active bookings (*double*), with none (*none*, the window a cancel-then-rebook opens when the rebooking fails), and sessions whose consumer acted on a date that is not the final one (*consumer stale*). The run is **[pending: runner step 18, three families]**; its table replaces this sentence, and until then the ledger's $0/100$ must be read as the store-level statement above and nothing more.

6.3 RQ1 across three disciplines: the AutoGen pilot

An instrumentation layer exposes a two-phase `begin`/`commit` API to LLM-driven agents under AutoGen [14]; the Rust runtimes of Section 5.2 sit behind it. Three workloads span the space from concurrent to sequential: *edit-review* (two agents both read `doc` before either writes—overlap forced), *plan-execute* (strictly sequential—overlap forbidden) and *triage* (a three-agent pipeline whose overlap is left to the models). gpt-4o, 100 sessions per cell, three runtimes (Table 4); the vanilla column was replicated three times (triage 42%, 48% and 52%; pooled 142/300). A Claude Sonnet 4.5 rerun of the vanilla column with operation records reproduces the two determinate cells (edit-review $100/100$, plan-execute $0/100$); its triage cell is void, and the cause is the workload, not the model: the reporter's prompt asks for "a one-sentence bug description" and supplies no bug, gpt-4o invents one, and Sonnet wrote "no bug description provided" in $100/100$ sessions. The pilot now hands the reporter a concrete bug drawn by scenario from a fixed list, records the protocol beside each cell, and the Sonnet triage cells are to be rerun under it (**[pending: runner step 11]**; supplement § M); the gpt-4o run of Table 4 predates the change and is reported as run.

Both endpoints are engineered, so the table is a sensitivity check of the detector and the runtimes on model-driven traces, not a prevalence; every edit-review witness is a cold-start read, unlike the live study's supersessions. Default-SI's residual is its no-write bypass (a read-only commit is never validated: the unfaithful emitter of Theorem L1j; SSI mode closes it). Pessimistic locking reaches 0% on edit-review by refusing the reviewer's operation in $99/100$ sessions—the anomaly is absent because the work is—and on triage by dropping one of three agents in $97/100$; the *complete & clean* row is the number to read a prevention claim against, and on triage it favors the unguarded baseline (52) over default-SI (45) and locking (3). Whether a dropped contribution or a stale one is the worse outcome is a property of the task, which is why Section 6.7 prices prevention per sound committed operation.

6.4 RQ1 for L_2: output commit on synthetic cascades and live verdicts

Three arms run the same 1,000 seeded schedules at nominal chain depths 2, 3 and 5: a root commits, a chain of dependents reads the previous cell and commits, one committed transaction is put under review and retracted or approved, and in a quarter of scenarios the review arrives after that transaction has released. The *verified* arm is `l2_exec.rs`; the *unguarded* arm validates reads, releases at commit and flags only the aborted transaction; the *cascade* arm releases at commit and cascades the abort. Each trace is scored under Definition 4, under the surviving-dependent predicate, and by *exposed effects*—effects out at the end although the review asked to withdraw their basis—which reads no flag (full table: supplement § P). The result is one structural fact. Definition 4 fires in 519, 624 and 563 of 1,000 schedules per depth under both baselines and in none under the verified arm; the cascade arm satisfies its own surviving-dependent predicate in every scenario while exposing exactly as many effects as no discipline at all (1,538, 2,059 and 2,010), because it flagged 767, 1,288 and 1,239 dependents *after* their effects were out—a cascade without output commit moves flags, not effects. The verified arm is not zero on exposed effects: 402, 547 and 549 effects in 199 scenarios per depth, exactly the scenarios in which the review arrived after the release and the retraction was refused. The figures decompose by arithmetic ($1{,}538 = 402 + 572 + 564$ at depth 2): the first term no runtime can remove; the second any runtime that declines to release an operation under review avoids; the third (37–46% of the unguarded exposure) is output commit's own contribution. Its cost is delay, not liveness (every committed, unaborted operation was eventually released). The quarter of late reviews is a harness parameter, so the overall exposure reduction (73–74%) is that parameter seen from the other side, not a finding.

Live verdicts. A plan–execute–revise workload driven by real models (a planner commits a plan; an executor reads it and commits, acquiring the planner as predecessor; a supervisor decides whether to retract) was recorded for 200 sessions on each of three families and replayed through the three arms. Retraction rates varied sharply—$1/200$ (claude-haiku-4-5), $3/200$ (gpt-4o-mini), $62/200$ (Llama-3.2)—so we make the pooled statement only: in every one of the 66 retracted sessions the unguarded baseline and the cascade design left a Definition 4 witness (the latter while satisfying the surviving-dependent predicate), and the verified runtime released no executor effect on a retracted plan, at a pooled release rate of 89.0%. A further 1,000 haiku sessions produced no retraction at all, so on that family the discipline's only observable cost is the hold: each kept effect waited for the supervisor's verdict, a median 687 ms (p90 789 ms). The zero is structural; the replay shows the discipline executing under supervisor behavior that ranges from $0/1{,}000$ to $62/200$ retractions, and the A_3 hazard itself is a property of the backbone's retraction rate.

6.5 RQ1 for L_3: a released tool executor reorders

LangGraph's `ToolNode` dispatches a turn's tool calls concurrently (`asyncio.gather`), collects results in input order and does not serialize side effects; its tracker records a user needing sequential execution for stateful tools and unable to obtain it (langgraphjs #861). We gave three backbones a natural prompt (no instruction to parallelize) over five order-dependent infrastructure tools whose docstrings state their dependencies, took the model-emitted call list as *io*, and dispatched it through the released `ToolNode` and

TABLE 5
Model-emitted batches through LangGraph's released `ToolNode` (`langgraph` 1.2.5), 30 turns per backbone, natural prompt. Tool latency modeled. *Transcript*: turns in which the returned `ToolMessage` list preserved issuance order although effects committed out of order.

Backbone	batched	full pipeline (5)	A_6, default	A_6, L_3
gpt-4o-mini	30/30	18 (18 reordered)	22/30	0/30
Llama-3.2	3/30	0	2/3	0/3
claude-haiku-4-5	0/30	0	—	—

Transcript preserved issuance order in 33/33 batched turns; 24 of them had committed out of order.

through the L_3 sequencer. In the table's cells two things are real—whether a backbone batches an order-dependent pipeline into one turn, and the executor—and per-tool latency is modeled, drawn uniformly from 10–200 ms (a uniform-latency control produces no reorder; the committed order is the latency argsort). The replay against real effects below removes the model.

The finding that survives the modeling is structural (Table 5): one backbone batches the full dependent pipeline on $18/30$ turns and reorders every one of them, another never batches, and the transcript a developer inspects shows the correct order in all 33 batched turns while the external state does not. Calls emitted in one turn are, by the provider's contract, calls the model declared parallelizable, so the defect is shared between a backbone that misjudged independence and an executor that cannot notice; the L_3 sequencer makes effect order independent of which backbone is in use, which is the property the cross-model spread shows cannot otherwise be assumed. Replaying the 33 recorded batches five times each through `ToolNode` against real effects—a WAL-backed SQLite database and a local HTTP service, with whatever latency those have—rather than a modeled sleep, baseline A_6 fires in $126/165$ replays (SQLite) and $112/165$ (HTTP): the reorder is a property of concurrent dispatch under any real latency, not of the distribution we drew. The L_3 arm of that replay issued the calls one at a time, which cannot reorder and measures nothing; the arm that counts—concurrent dispatch through the same executor, each real effect released only when the verified sequencer of Section 5.4 releases it—is **[pending: runner step 15]**.

6.6 RQ1 for L_4: validation at dispatch

One seeded schedule per run pins a tool and then revokes or re-signs random tools; three dispatchers act on the same registry. Over 1,000 runs at registry widths 2, 4 and 16 the churn touched the planned tool in 630, 505 and 387 runs, and in exactly those runs both live resolution and snapshot resolution called a phantom—Theorem L_4d measured rather than argued—while the verified dispatcher (`l4_exec.rs`, the verified bytes) called none and refused exactly those runs. The informative figures are the hazard rate and the refusal cost; the zero is Theorem L_4b executing.

6.7 RQ2: what prevention costs

The pilot driver captures per-call usage and wall-clock for every session of run `20260913T0150Z` (gpt-4o, 900 sessions) and of its Claude Sonnet 4.5 replication; pricing is list price at the time of the run. Per session, snapshot isolation's token cost is not separable from the unguarded runtime's on either provider (overlapping intervals in every cell), and pessimistic locking's overhead is provider-dependent (at most $1.6\times$ on gpt-4o and $2.2\times$ on Claude, both on triage, where it retries). A per-session denominator, however, credits a discipline for work it declined to do. Table 6 re-prices the same run per committed operation and per *sound* committed operation—one that is not the stale reader of any Definition 1 witness—so that no runtime earns credit for output an anomaly has invalidated.

TABLE 6
Token cost of prevention under three denominators, gpt-4o, run `20260913T0150Z`. Per sound committed operation is the price we recommend reading. Underlying counts (commits / sound): edit-review vanilla $212/112$, pessimistic $101/101$, SI $110/105$; triage vanilla $335/283$, pessimistic $205/205$, SI $268/256$; plan-execute $\approx 200/200$ for all three.

Workload	Discipline	per session	per commit	per sound commit
edit-review	pessimistic	$+3.8\%$	$+117.9\%$	$+15.1\%$
edit-review	SI	$+0.6\%$	$+94.0\%$	$+7.4\%$
plan-execute	pessimistic	$+1.7\%$	$+1.2\%$	$+1.2\%$
plan-execute	SI	$+0.4\%$	$+0.4\%$	$+0.4\%$
triage	pessimistic	$+42.7\%$	$+133.2\%$	$+97.0\%$
triage	SI	$+0.5\%$	$+25.6\%$	$+11.1\%$

Between-session parity does not survive the change of denominator: snapshot isolation costs $+7.4\%$, $+0.4\%$ and $+11.1\%$ per sound committed operation, and pessimistic locking's triage penalty is $+97\%$ rather than $+43\%$. Overhead tracks realized contention: edit-review, which aborts hardest, pays most; plan-execute, which never aborts, pays at most $+1.7\%$ under any denominator. A separate 155-session paired sweep on gpt-4o-mini (fan-in 2–16 at one cell; 2–32 cells at fan-in 8; realized abort rates 0.09–0.93) resolves the mechanism: snapshot isolation carries no fixed overhead (intercept $+0.05\%$, CI $[-1.5, +1.7]$) and pays $1.074\times$ $[1.052, 1.096]$ a first-attempt generation per abort, because the retry carries the conflict into its prompt; the per-abort price does not steepen with contention (supplement § M).

Wall-clock, with its confound. The nine cells of a run were executed one after another, so a difference between cells carries whatever the provider's latency did in between. Plan-execute, on which no runtime aborts, is the control, and its "overheads" are -4.5% and -4.9% on gpt-4o (Holm-corrected permutation $p = 0.014$, 0.002) and $+13.5\%$ for SI on Claude ($p = 0.001$): that is drift, and we report its largest magnitude as the run's null band. Outside it, on mean and median alike: pessimistic locking at $+16.7\%$ (edit-review) and $+34.9\%$ (triage) on gpt-4o and $+109.5\%$ (triage) on Claude, where it makes 7.75 model calls per session against 4.00. Snapshot isolation is inside the band in every cell on both families, which is not the same as zero: the design cannot resolve an overhead below about 5% on gpt-4o or 14% on Claude, and the per-sound-commit wall-clock overheads on gpt-4o, $+4.9\%$ $[-2.8, +13.5]$ and $+11.0\%$ $[-2.5, +26.1]$, have intervals that include both zero and the band (every cell, with its receipt, in supplement § O). Only a rerun with the three runtimes interleaved per session removes the confound; probe 302 is that design. Its Claude Sonnet 4.5 run is **[pending: runner step 6]**; the gpt-4o rerun is not planned, so the gpt-4o wall-clock cells above stand with their null band and no finer claim is made for them.

6.8 Operational materiality of a firing

A value mismatch may be lexical. Holding an agent's context fixed and varying only the shared value it read, the decision changed in $150/200$ flagged mismatches of a controlled triage task (75.0% $[68.4, 80.8]$); the rate is a property of the pairs sampled as much as of the agents, offered as the paper's only value-staleness estimate,

not a constant. On the pilot's Definition 1 firings materiality is $43/43$ under an LLM judge, blind-coded by hand on 15; in the live study the stale date reached the booking text in 150 of 152 firings (September run, three families).

6.9 RQ3: where the preconditions occur

Every occurrence figure above is a race we opened or a rate on our own workloads. To put a denominator under the structural precondition of A_1 in the framework we studied—a reader and a writer of one last-value channel released into the same superstep—we analyzed public code; the answer is a bracket, *none confirmed, at most about half*, and we state it as one. *Frame*: GitHub repositories matching `langgraph` in name, description or readme (Python; forks and the framework's own organization excluded), in three star bands; 60 drawn per band under a fixed seed from the API's 500 most recently updated. *Instrument*: a static front end that recovers, from the syntax tree alone, each `StateGraph` site, the node pairs one fork releases into a superstep, and each node's read and written keys; whatever it cannot resolve is *unknown*, never guessed (eleven fixtures pin its rules; a differential oracle agrees with execution on the eight runnable ones).

All 180 sampled repositories were read (60 per star band; per-band counts in supplement § Q); 98 contain a visible graph, holding 407 sites, of which 392 (96%) are sequential. Fifteen sites in 11 repositories (11.2%, Wilson 95% $[6.4, 19.0]$) contain a co-scheduled pair; none is a confirmed reader/writer pair on a last-value channel (repository-level upper limit 3.8%); two are such pairs on a reducer channel, the ordinary parallel-agents-on-`messages` idiom; eight have an unresolved side, bounding the susceptible share at 8.2% $[4.2, 15.3]$ of repositories. Counting every unresolved site (82 with routing the front end could not resolve, 7 with a `Send` fan-out) gives a wide bound of 51%; restricting to the 251 source-path sites changes nothing. An enriched population—the 34 third-party repositories whose issues quote LangGraph's co-superstep writer/writer error, projects that demonstrably ran parallel writers—has parallel graphs in $12/26$ but again no confirmed site in 391. The bracket is *none confirmed, at most about half*; the narrow reading is a negative result for the motivation of Section 6.1, recorded as one; the census measures how code is written, not how often a graph runs or whether a co-scheduled read goes stale.

Mechanisms, not rates. Of five deployed designs we probed, four close the window and one leaves it open: Letta re-renders the shared block into every generation step; LangGraph's `interrupt` re-executes a node from its start on resume; CrewAI rejects a concurrent read of a concurrently produced value at construction; AutoGen's actors own their state. LangGraph's superstep channels and cross-thread store pin a read across a node body that may contain a model call, which is where Section 6.1 measures it. Five systems is not a sample; each entry names a mechanism a designer can choose. Two framework defects outside the catalog were found on the way: the widely cited deer-flow bug (#3123) is a sequential blind overwrite under a last-value channel, not a concurrency anomaly, and `interrupt`'s re-execution emits an effect issued before the gate twice (supplement § Q).

6.10 Threats to validity

Construct. A_1 tracks the window, not the harm; Table 3 reports both and R names the gap. The basis is argument provenance, verbatim and not semantic. Whether a booking that disagrees with a later revision is harm is the application's call; we count it because the user asked for one trip. A_6 fires on commuting effects and is silent on dropped ones. *Internal.* The live rates are latency races, $n = 100$ single runs per cell, at one offset in Table 3 and four in Figure 2; the wall-clock cells carry a run-order confound we bound rather than remove (probe 302 removes it; not run); the L2 live replay rests on 66 retractions, 62 from one family (1,000 further haiku sessions added none). *External.* Three API families and one local; one framework driven live; toy workloads of two to three agents. *Reproducibility.* Every cell is committed with its traces and rescored by an independent implementation of Definition 1; run `20260913T0424Z` carries a manifest captured at run time, the two earlier runs carry reconstructed manifests that say so.

7 Related work

7.1 Classical consistency and isolation

The hardware tradition [5], [6] characterizes visibility under bounded latency; ours is unbounded. The database isolation hierarchy [7]–[9] is the direct ancestor: we adopt its anomaly-based method over a different operational model, and the SSI line [12], [18], [23] is the reference for our SSI runtime, the difference being that the work discarded on abort is an inference. Weikum and Vossen's commit-order-preserving serializability [3] and Kung and Robinson's backward validation [4] are what Theorem 1 mechanizes at the level of values read; view equivalence [24] is where the value-level and conflict-level notions meet. Highly available transactions [65] classify levels by admitted anomalies, the method our lattice borrows; Cerone et al. [25] give the axiomatic framework our predicates specialize; *robustness* [26] is what the census asks statically; our detectors are polynomial only because each predicate is existential over a constant number of records. Compensation descends from sagas [17], ConTracts [46] and Gray and Reuter [52]; recoverability and strictness are Hadzilacos [42] and Bernstein et al. [16]. Irrevocable transactions [27] and transactional boosting [53] met the same irreversibility in transactional memory; output commit is the dual choice. Commutativity-based control [66] orders only what does not commute, and an A_6 discipline over commutativity classes would pay the sequencing cost only where it buys something—the normative premise of A_6, that effect order must match issuance order, holds only for non-commuting effects, and our predicate over-reports on the rest. The basis of Definition 6 is why-provenance [67] restricted to copying. Exactly-once stream processing [69] holds side effects at a transactional sink until the input is durable, the industrial precedent for output commit. The pessimistic/optimistic choice our cost analysis turns on is STM's contention-management problem, and the cost-aware selection of a level is consistency rationing [54] and TxnSails [51].

7.2 Concurrency control and shared memory for LLM agents

A 2025–2026 line builds mechanisms for this regime, mostly without verifying them, and the present paper is one point in it rather than its origin. Agentic transactions [70] recast ACID as four semantic guarantees for a single long-horizon agent (explore–execute–validate cycles, dependency-aware isolation) and measure task success, with no history predicate, model or proof; our catalog is the anomaly-level account such guarantees would be checked against, and supplement § D places it on the lattice with the systems below. CoAgent [36] states the regime in our three terms and proposes an advisory protocol in which a notified agent repairs

its own plan; its correctness argument is conditional on a model judgment measured at a 5% failure rate, and its lock/OCC cost inversion independently reproduces Section 6.7. STORM [37] is read validation (L_1) deployed per file; ATCC [39] and GoEX [40] impose a remedy from the runtime. MemTX [55] is the closest design to our L_2: staged writes under snapshot isolation, irreversible tool calls gated on current belief and cascading repair on retraction, with two invariants checked by bounded enumeration (5.5M states) and a five-backbone evaluation; it does not state the predicates it excludes, verify the runtime, or price prevention per unit of sound work. Yang et al. [56] argue that coordination failures attributed to communication are concurrency failures; governed shared memory [57] and transactive memory [58] address provenance, supersession and scoping without treating the generation window as a transaction. TOKI [72] is the closest formal treatment of supersession: it casts contradiction resolution in agent memory as write-time concurrency control, names the isolation each resolution operator presupposes and the write anomalies it admits, and proves soundness of a bitemporal operator family; it governs which belief a memory keeps, where R governs what an effect already out still owes, and the two are complementary. SAFEFLOW [73] combines transactional execution with information-flow labels and write-ahead rollback at the coordination layer, and Cordon [74] stages external actions in an effect outbox released only after whole-workflow validation—output commit at task granularity without a model of concurrent tasks or a proof. StateFuse [75] keeps conflicting observations visible under CRDT merging, a contract orthogonal to exclusion like CodeCRDT's. Yu et al. [76] ask whether a shared memory, however consistent, suffices for an agent's task duties, a question above the history level at which we work. SagaLLM [1], Atomix [2] and CodeCRDT [22] are placed on the lattice informally in supplement § D; none reaches L_4; supplement § V compares the nearest systems dimension by dimension. S-Bus [38] (the author's prior work) recovers implicit read sets for one contract and is the natural supplier of trust-base item (ix), with the limit stated there. Agent-memory systems [45] and the frameworks [14], [71] supply substrate, not contract.

7.3 Commit-time guards, retraction, and what comes after commit

The 2026 work on agent effects acts at the commit boundary: CommitGuard [61] licenses a durable effect only by a witness still fresh at commit; Zheng et al. [62] show that freshness guards of our L_1 kind block 92–95% of benign infrastructure races and argue for semantic commit predicates; EffectMatch [63] validates persistent outcomes against what was approved; versioned execution [64] revokes an obsolete execution's authority to publish. MemTX [55] alone looks past commit: on an explicit *retraction* it walks a derivation DAG to executed tool actions and records each as compensated or leaked. None treats the ordinary case Table 3 measures—no retraction, no race, a legitimate later write—and none states what guarantee is achievable there; the remark of Section 3.6 says it is an obligation under an open-world store, and the ledger registers it atomically. The precision objection of Zheng et al. is answered at the basis: a basis predicate ignores writes to cells the effect never depended on.

7.4 Effect order, durable execution, verified systems, taxonomies

Parallel function calling is pursued deliberately (LLMCompiler [32], asynchronous calling [59]), with the ordering of effects left to the runtime; A_6 is a wrong independence judgment seen at the effect level (Section 6.5). Sandboxes and policies for tool effects [34], [60] gate *what* an agent may do, orthogonally to the order and basis of effects; τ-bench [33] scores end state for a single agent. Durable-execution engines [35] and exactly-once workflow systems [44] govern whether an effect is *repeated* after a crash—the property D of Section 3.7 names—while output commit governs whether it may *leave* while its basis can be withdrawn, and the two compose; rollback recovery discharges duplicates by identity because replay is deterministic, a premise agent runtimes break [50]. Retro [43] repair effects that have already left by compensating requests; a refused retraction in our L_2 is such an effect. IronFleet [28] verify running protocols and stores, and Perennial [47] verify crash-safe storage by layered refinement, the template for the open step of Section 5.2; ours are far smaller, and what they add is verified bytes executed in a measurement. Jepsen [29] and the black-box checkers [30], [31] decide serializability over database histories with unverified analyzers under a uniqueness assumption we share (Section 3.3); ours decide a far simpler property and are verified against it, in the tradition of runtime verification [48]. MAST [11] catalogs cognitive and coordination failures and its traces cannot show A_1 either way (supplement § C); Agentproof [41] analyzes agent graphs statically, the programme the census specializes; MCMAS [49] verify task-level and strategic properties, a complementary layer.

8 Limitations and Future Work

The predicates are coarser than the phenomena. A_1 over-reports in one shape (a value overwritten and restored inside the window; 0 of 710 witness pairs on the live records) and, as Table 3 shows, under-reaches the harm by the post-commit supersession that R names. A_6 fires on commuting effects and is blind to dropped and duplicated ones. The detectors are sound and complete against their Verus specifications; Table 2 says for each where the specification and the catalog definition coincide and under what hypothesis.

R is not an anomaly, and its basis is syntactic. R fires in $100/100$ sequential sessions because the workload revises the date in every session; what Table 3 establishes is that the harm an isolation discipline cannot reach is exactly this predicate, not that concurrency causes it, which is why it stands outside the catalog. Its basis is argument provenance: a value that appears verbatim in an effect's arguments. A booking derived from the date by computation ("the day after") has an empty basis and is invisible, so the extractor under-reaches and the R column is a lower bound; on this workload its coverage is 4,500/4,500 because the booking tool takes the date as a structured argument, and a workload with free-text effects needs a declared or taint-tracked basis. Whether a registered obligation is discharged, and at what cost, is a property of the compensator; the ledger's guarantee ends at registration, and the ledger arm of Table 3 measures one compensator on one workload.

A refused retraction is not a prevented anomaly. Output commit makes Definition 4 unreachable partly by holding effects and partly by refusing to retract an operation whose effects are out; the second leaves the world as it was and is counted (Section 6.4). The exposure–latency curve between the harness's one point and the live driver's extreme is unmeasured.

Verification is relative to the trace, and the triangle closes on one system only in part. Trust-base item (ix) is the largest and

is measured only at the store boundary: a value that reaches the model through prompt context is invisible, and our own read-set reconstruction finds most reads invisible on a realistic workload [38]. The published A_1 verdicts stand on a gated port until the rescoring through the verified bytes is committed; A_2, A_3 and A_6 remain ports gated against their specifications. The refinement from the two concurrent stores to their abstract machines is open (a bounded simulation over 506,880 transitions is evidence, not a proof); the L_2–L_4 exec artifacts are sequential objects a multi-threaded caller must serialize; the ledger arm's executable is harness code and the ledger's Verus model is scaffolding. Liveness is verified nowhere.

Prevalence is not established, and the census points the other way. The census bounds a structural precondition in public code (none confirmed; at most about half counting every unresolved site) and says nothing about private deployments, run frequency or the cross-thread store variant; its reading is that public LangGraph code rarely contends. Whether these anomalies occur in production at a rate that justifies the costs of Section 6.7 is open; the live rates are latency races, and Table 3's arms are sequential blocks whose between-arm differences we do not attribute.

Pending, each a step of the artifact's runner and each marked in the text where its receipt will land: the rescoring of every cell through the verified detector (step 14); the replay with the verified L_3 bytes (15); the replicated, interleaved live study with the ledger over the verified store (17); the ledger in a world (18); the interleaved cost rerun on Claude (6) and the Claude pilot's triage cells under the seeded-ticket protocol (11); longer tasks, more agents and an instrumented deployment remain the empirical follow-up; the store refinements, the formal one.

9 Conclusion

Four classical consistency conditions port to the regime in which an agent's step spans an inference call, and the development is mechanized at stated assurance levels: TLA$^+$ predicates with TLC witnesses, a realizability matrix over every point of their exclusion lattice at stated bounds, a TLAPS theorem placing stale-generation freedom as a conditional commit-order read consistency, Verus detectors sound and complete against their specifications with each specification's relation to its definition named, and four disciplines verified in Verus and compiled byte-identical into the runtime, three of them executed as the bytes that were verified. What the four leave is not an anomaly: an effect out on a basis later writes revise, which under an open-world store can only be owed, and for which a basis ledger registers the obligation atomically at every lattice point and, with a compensator, removes the residue on the store on three API families—while a world with a consumer and a fallible compensator is where the ledger's worth must be measured, and is not yet. The evaluation's contribution is not the verified arms' zeros, which are theorems, but what sits beside them: the harm each discipline leaves (R in 2–63% of live sessions under L_1 at 150 ms and up to 52% as the race offset grows; 402–549 exposed effects per 1,000 cascades under L_2), its cost per unit of sound work ($+0.4$–11% for snapshot isolation, up to $+97\%$ for locking), where the preconditions occur in deployed code (nowhere confirmed in 407 public LangGraph sites for A_1; $30/30$ turns of one backbone's tool batching for A_6; a resumption path that emits an effect twice), and which comparisons its own design cannot support. A discipline should be judged by all of these; the artifact re-derives each from committed data.

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